2. Logging in as a System User

Graeme Bunting
1 year ago · Updated

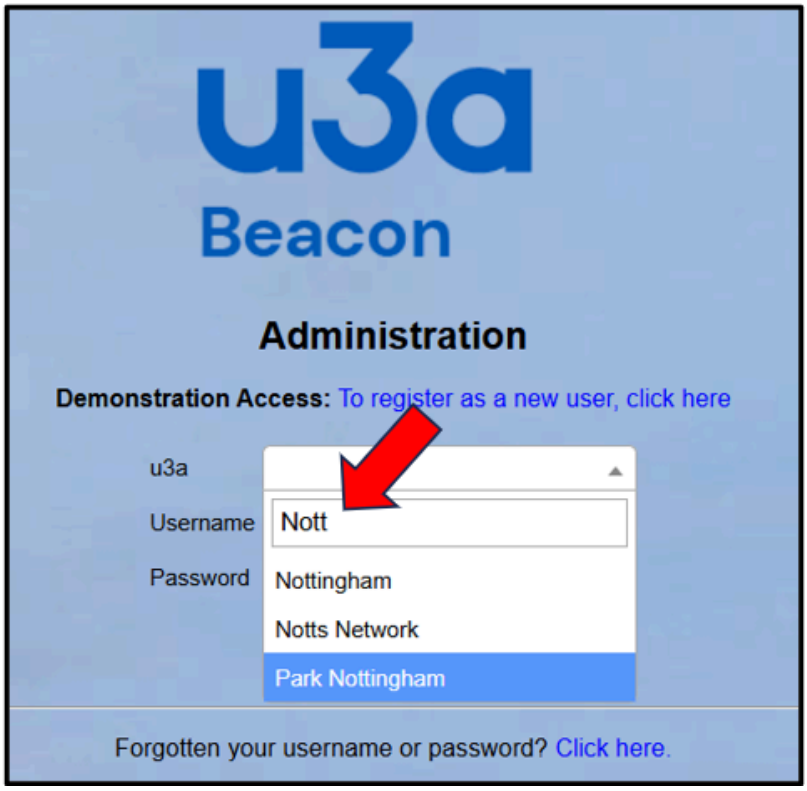
The Beacon log-in page is located at https://u3abeacon.org.uk

After clicking into the **u3a** drop-down list you can scroll down using the slider on the right to find and select your u3a:

Help

click into the box where it says "*Type to search u3a sites*" and enter part of your u3a name to show a shortened list of u3a's to select from. This method is the better one to use with a touch-screen such

as on a tablet or phone:



Having selected your u3a, enter your **Username** and **Password,** which will have been sent to you by your Site Administrator, and press the **Enter** button:

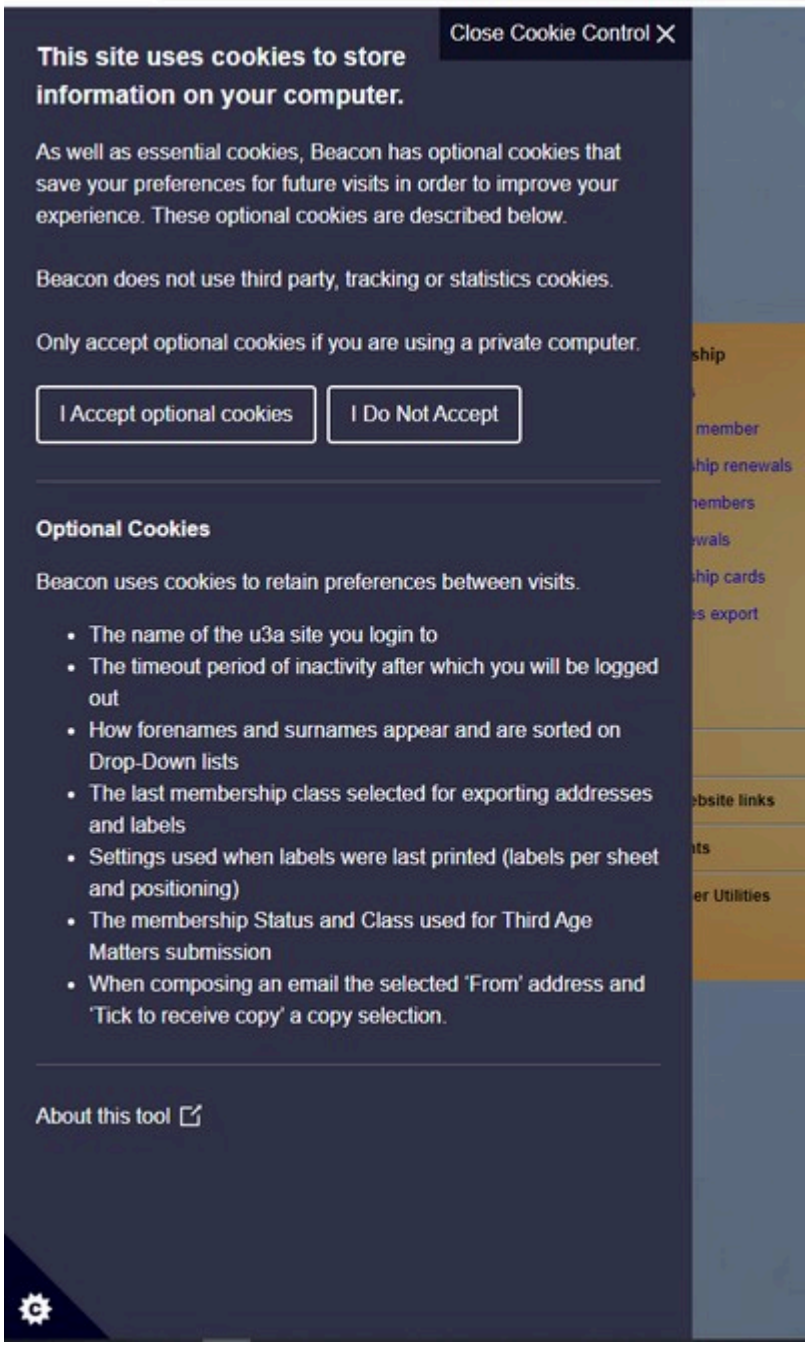
- You are allowed four attempts to log in. If the fourth try fails, another attempt will not be accepted for 15 minutes. You may be able to avoid this delay by closing and re-opening your browser.
  With some browser/device combinations you will need to delete your browser's cookies. If you wish to selectively delete Beacon's cookies look for u3abeacon.org.uk.

- If you continue to be unable to log in, seek the assistance of your Site Administrator who will confirm your username and may re-set your password.

If you have forgotten your username or password, use the **Click here** link at the bottom of the screen or contact your Site Administrator.

Cookie Control

The fist time you land on this page, and occasionally after that, the Cookie Control appears. It describes the optional cookies that your browser can store to remember a range of handy preferences for your next visit. If you are using a public or shared computer always click "**I Do Not Accept**". Closing the control without making a choice is the equivalent of "**I Do Not Accept**".
You can open the cookie control at any time by clicking the cog in the black triangle located at the bottom left of every Beacon screen.



If you keep seeing the Cookie Control prompt on every page then your browser is blocking the cookie that remembers your choice. The Norton Antitrack browser add-on has been reported to do this.

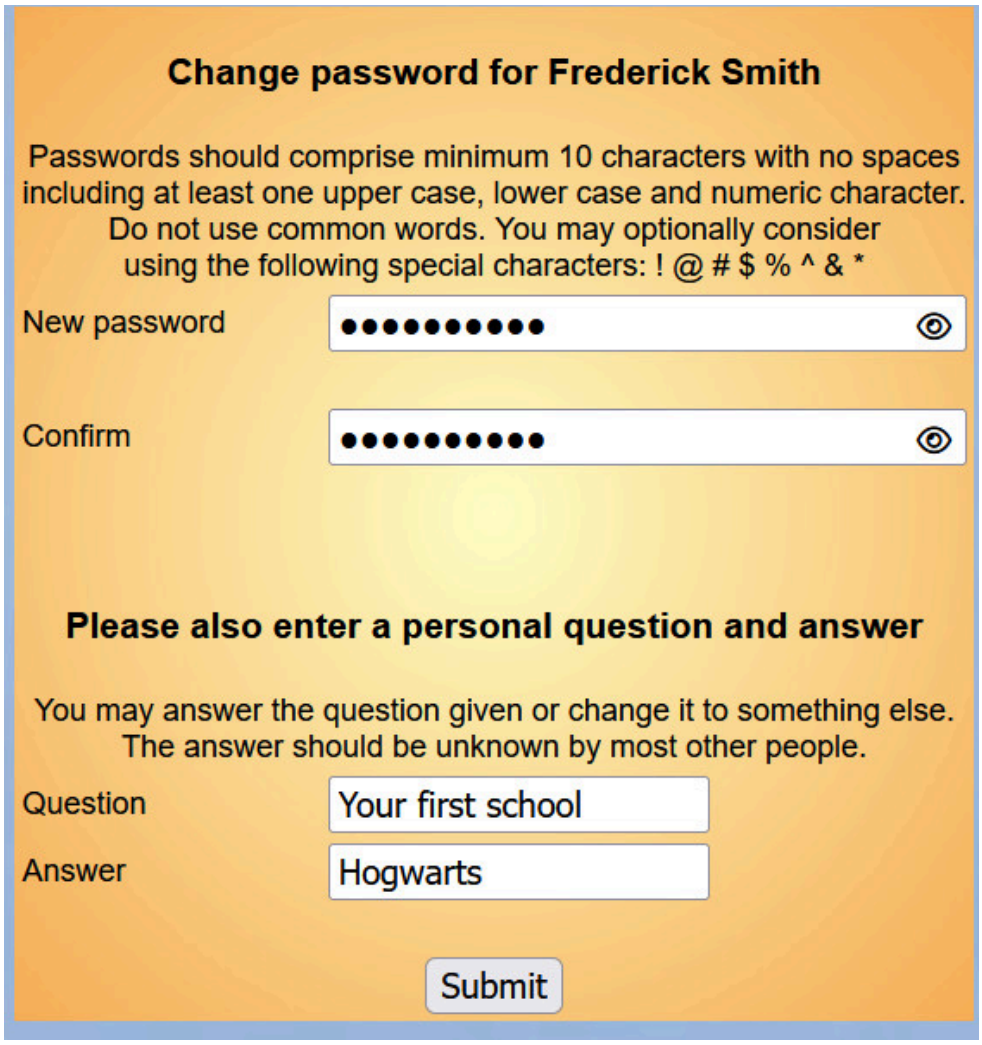
The cookies control can also be used to clear your Beacon cookies. Click on the cog then "I Do Not Accept". Then click on the cog again and click "I Accept optional cookies"

Password Management

If you have not used the system before, or if your password has been re-set by a Site Administrator, you will be prompted to change your password and set a Security Question and Answer.

Enter your new password in the **New password** box and enter it again in the **Confirm** box. As you type there will be hints displayed to tell you whether you have chosen a good password, if it meets the format requirements and if the 2 entries match.

You can accept the default **Question** (your first school) or change it to something else. Make sure that the **Answer** is something that you will remember (including the format) but which is unlikely to be known to anyone else.



After pressing the **Submit** button you will be taken to the **Beacon Home page**

Revision History

v2	2020-08-11	Graham Tigg	Added may need to remove cookies for 15-minute timeout
v3	2020-12-09	John Alexander	Amended to say passwords can be pasted.
v4	2022-02-17	Graham Tigg	Updated for cookie control
v5	2022-05-21	Graham Tigg	Suggestions with cookie control issues

v6	2022-08-16	Graham Tigg	Replaced screenshot. Added that the cookie control can be used to clear cookies.
v7	2023-08-22	Graeme Bunting	Now allowed 4 attempts to log-in, previously 3
v8	2024-08-29	Graeme Bunting	New method of selecting your u3a name added

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Peter Goatly

5 years ago

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I suggest that Section 2 of the User Guide entitled "Logging in as a System User" should be changed. This is because the words "Passwords should be typed, not pasted. Correct verification will not take place for pasted passwords." are relevant to changing passwords, but do not apply when logging in. I have successfully pasted in passwords when logging in, but I mistakenly pasted in a 17-character password when changing my password. This password appeared to have been accepted by Beacon as it produced no error message. Actually, Beacon only accepted the first 15 characters of the password (as this is the maximum length it should accept) and this caused me to get a login failure when I attempted to use the full 17-character password.

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